

Industry News

Skilled immigrants returning home

The US has always been the strongest magnet for the world's best and brightest, but there are other strong magnets now. More and more highly skilled immigrants including engineers, scientists and researchers are leaving the United States to return to their own countries, mainly due to better career opportunities, according to a new study released by the Ewing Marion Kauffman Foundation. The move will greatly boost the economies of India and China and undermine technological innovation in America.

The study by a team at Duke, Harvard and Berkeley universities was led by Vivek Wadhwa, an Indian-American technology entrepreneur turned academic.

In the two-year study of 1203 Indian and Chinese subjects who had studied or worked in the US for a year or more before returning home, it was found that most of the Indian and Chinese immigrant subjects who returned to their home countries were relatively young (35 and 37, respectively), male, married and had no children. These returnees had degrees primarily in management, technology or science, with most holding Master's and PhD degrees. The most common professional factor (86.8 per cent of Chinese and 79 per cent of Indians) motivating workers to return home was the growing demand for their skills in their home countries.

PC sales decline 19 per cent

"The total PC sales between October and December 2008, with desktop and notebook computers taken together, were 1.4 million units, registering a decline of 19 per cent over the same period last fiscal," according to Manufacturers' Association for Information

Top-level reshuffle at Bharti Airtel

Bharti Airtel has reshuffled top-level management to lay the foundation for the company's next phase of growth. It has promoted Sanjay Kapoor to the position of deputy CEO. Kapoor was earlier the company's president for mobile services. In the new role, he will look after mobile, telemedia and direct-to-home (DTH) television services.

Manoj Kohli, the company's CEO and joint managing director, will increasingly focus on strategy development, governance and organisation development.

Atul Bindal has been appointed as president-mobile services and

K. Srinivas as joint president-telemedia services. Bindal currently heads the telemedia business, while K. Srinivas is executive director (east)-mobile services and in-charge of Sri Lanka operations.

TI appoints new MD in India

Dr Biswadip (Bobby) Mitra, who most recently served as director of the America's wireless communication product development activities at Texas Instruments (TI), Dallas, has been named president and managing director of TI India. In this new role, Dr Mitra will lead all of TI's research and development, sales and marketing activities in India.

Technology (MAIT). The sales of desktops stood at one million units, while notebooks recorded a consumption of 350,000 units.

Given the current macro-economic conditions and the buying sentiment in the market, overall PC sales for 2008-09 are expected to remain at the same levels as in the last fiscal at 7.3 million units.

Slash import duty on security gadgets: ASSOCHAM

ASSOCHAM has advocated the need for reduction in import tariffs on security-related electronic products by at least 50 per cent with a view to strengthen the domestic security systems industry. Import duties currently hover around 37 per cent for most of the electronic security gadgets and around 12.5 per cent for telecom equipment and power conditioners, which makes installation of security gadgets an expensive exercise.

ASSOCHAM has therefore stressed on the need to slash import tariffs on electronic security products to 18.5 per cent from over 37 per cent and nil on the telecom equipment

and power conditioners.

Infineon microcontrollers for e-passports

Infineon Technologies will supply contactless security microcontrollers for India's electronic passport programme. The rollout has started with the issuance of electronic passports to Indian diplomats and officials, and it is expected that in this first phase, up to 30,000 electronic passports shall be issued. By September 2009, the programme is likely to be expanded to include passports used by the general public.

Designed to facilitate international travel by allowing automatic identity verification, fast immigration inspections combined with efficient border protection and security, the new electronic passports include a security microcontroller in the back cover of the passport that securely stores the same information as printed on the document.

Sony eyes low-end segment

Sony India plans to gain market share in its low-end segment across